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MONEY

ON THE INTERNET

ROBIN NOBLES

Internet offers black history facts, figures

Monday, January 18, is Martin Luther King, Jr., day, and February is Black History Month. On the Internet, you can find information about King's life, his goals, and his death. You can also discover some marvelous resources that will help you learn more about African American history.

Let's begin at The African-American Mosaic Exhibition, a Library of Congress Resource Guide for the Study of Black History and Culture.

The Mosaic covers nearly 500 years of the black experience in the Western Hemisphere and includes books, periodicals, prints, photographs, music, film, and recorded sound.

The online exhibit covers four areas: colonization, abolition, migrations, and the Works Project Administration (WPA). At the exhibition, you can read narratives from ex-slaves or study about the destination of the Great Migration, Chicago.

http://lcweb.loc.gov/exhibits/african/intro.html

Mississippi State University sponsors an impressive website, African American History: Historical Text Archive. Scroll down to People, then look for Martin Luther King, Jr., for numerous links highlighting the life of this famous civil rights hero.

Be sure to follow the link to the Martin Luther King, Jr., website at Stanford University.

http://www.msstate.edu/Archives/History/USA/Afro-Amer/afro.html

In 1947, the U.S. population was 150,697,361. The Black population was 15,042,286 (10 percent). Your Internet resource for Black history information is Black Facts Online, which offers a search engine for finding facts about Black history.

http://www.blackfacts.com/

"I have a dream that my four children will one day live in a nation where they will not be judged by the color of their skin but by the content of their character," said Martin Luther King, Jr.

Teachers will find an abundance of information for the study of Black History Month at the Martin Luther King Day website.

http://www.teacherzone.com/holidays/king98.html

The African American Web Connection is a community website for African Americans that offers a chat room as well as links to resources in art and poetry, authors, entertainment, and history.

http://www.aawc.com/aawc.html

"He who forgets the past is doomed to repeat it." TheBlackMarket.com website features little known facts about slavery.

Did you know that some enslaved children

n began doing small chores at the age of four or five, and by the age of 7, many were working regular hours?

http://theblackmarket.com/slavefaq.htm

We'll close by visiting NetNoir, another impressive online community for African Americans.

Access chat rooms, bulletin boards, or read the latest news stories.

Learn about jobs, business loans, or communities for teens, gospel or women.

http://www.netnoir.com/

■ Robin Nobles is a freelance writer who can be reached at RobinsNest@hattiesburg.net. This column can be viewed online at http://hattiesburg.net.

Jittery Dow suffers steep slide

NEW YORK (AP) — Stocks plunged on Wall Street Thursday as investors' worries grew about economic turmoil in Brazil and corporate profits and the impeachment trial at home.

The Dow Jones industrial average tumbled 228.63, or by 2.4 percent, to 9,120.93, dropping below where it started the year, at 9,181.43. That brought losses this week to 5.4 percent from the record 9,643.32 reached Friday.

The technology-heavy Nasdaq composite index fell 39.92, or by 1.7 percent, to 2,276.89, according to preliminary closing figures, but remained above where it began the year, at 2,192.69.

It was the Dow's fourth consecutive losing session and the Nasdaq's third straight fall. Trading was heavy, but well below Wednesday's frenzied pace.

The market's decline accelerated in afternoon trading as the impeachment proceedings against President Clinton began in Washington and Brazilian stocks nosedived.

The main index of the Sao Paulo stock exchange, the largest in Latin America, ended down 10 percent after trading was halted for a half-hour due to steep losses. The Bovespa index had dropped 5 percent Wednesday.

Other global markets finished mixed today.

The Dow had opened lower after Eastman Kodak reported its fourth-quarter earnings were well below analysts' expectations, sending Kodak shares down more than 10 percent. Kodak is one of the 30 stocks in Wall Street's most-watched market indicator.

Consumer stocks with heavy exposure to Latin America, such as Philip Morris and Coke, also were lower for the second straight day.

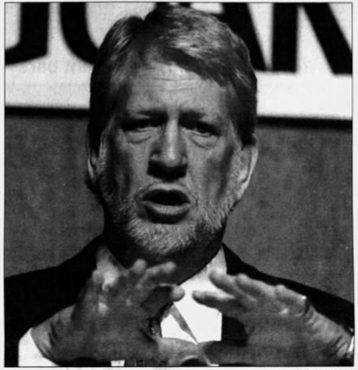
On Wednesday, the Dow fell 125.12 points to 9,349.56 after the devaluation of Brazil's battered currency, the real, and the sudden resignation of its top central banker increased worries that the country's turmoil would infect the rest of the region. Brazil is Latin America's largest economy and a major U.S. trading partner.

After tumbling Wednesday, European markets opened higher, but London's main stock index closed down 0.5 percent and German stocks fell 1.6 percent in response to Wall Street's downturn. French stocks, however, maintained their gains and finished 1 percent higher.

"Yesterday's drop was justified in light of what happened in Brazil, ... but today people are going to take a step back and realize there's really no reason to panic," said Andres Marinovic, a trader with Credit Lyonnais Securities in Paris.

WorldCom's president outlines goals

Keeping Jordan as spokesman is a done deal



The Associated Press

BIG PLANS: Bernard Ebbers, president and CEO of MCI WorldCom Inc., tells Mississippi banking executives and officials that global expansion, Internet growth and employment gains are the primary goals of his company this year.

JACKSON (AP) — Global expansion, Internet growth and employment gains are the main goals of MCI WorldCom Inc. this year, the company's top officer said.

The one factor that will remain constant, said Bernard J. Ebbers, MCI Worldcom's president and CEO, is his company's association with sports great Michael Jordan, who retired from pro basketball Wednesday.

"We knew he would not be playing basketball for 10 years when we entered into the agreement with him," said Ebbers. "We stick with Michael."

Ebbers' comments came during and immediately after an economic symposium in Jackson hosted by Deposit Guaranty National Bank.

"The international market is larger and growing faster than the U.S. market," Ebbers said. "The greatest potential for growth is out of the United States. The international market will almost double in the next two years."

Jackson-based MCI WorldCom plans to meet the needs of its international customers by building a 2,000-mile fiber-optic network throughout Europe, Ebbers said.

"We are building the most extensive network in Europe. By far and away we are ahead of any of our competitors there. We want to meet the needs of our multinational customers," he said.

Increased interest and growth in the Internet has challenged MCI WorldCom to expand and keep its technology current, Ebbers said.

WorldCom closed one of the nation's biggest telecommunications mergers by joining with MCI Communications Corp. last September. The merger created a colossus that provides a full range of services to 22 million customers worldwide. MCI WorldCom is the nation's second-largest long-distance provider behind AT&T.

"We will continue to expand the capability of our network," Ebbers said. "We are very excited about the Internet capabilities. Its phenomenal what's going to happen on the Internet."

Although most mergers usually result in layoffs, that will not be the case with MCI WorldCom, Ebbers said.

"Expect a net increase growth of 8,000 people per year over the next several years," Ebbers said.

Concerning Jordan, who is featured in MCI WorldCom promotions, Ebbers said he saw no reason the athlete's retirement would have a negative impact on the telecommunications giant.

"We anticipated that (his retirement) when we did this transaction with Michael," he said.

The Associated Press

IN CHARGE: Jack Guynn, president and CEO of the Federal Reserve Bank of Atlanta, tells state banking executives and officials in Jackson that bolstered by its casinos. Guynn's comments came during an economic symposium.

Economic experts expect growth to move at slower pace this year

JACKSON (AP) – Mississippi's casino-fueled economy can expect some growth in 1999, but it is unlikely to match the national or regional rates, according to the head of the Federal Reserve Bank of Atlanta.

Jack Guynn, the institution's president and CEO, said Mississippi experienced 1 percent employment growth in 1998 but national and regional growth was 2 percent. He said he anticipated similar patterns in 1999.

Gov. Kirk Fordice has cited unprecedented growth since 1992. He has claimed more than 177,000 new jobs had been created during that time. The casino industry and related businesses accounted for more than 57,000 jobs over that same period, according to industry representatives.

The casinos with their multi-million dollar hotels and gaming houses also created a construction boom that could reach its peak with the opening this spring of the $650 million Beau Rivage in Biloxi.

Guynn, speaking Wednesday at an economic symposium in Jackson hosted by Deposit Guaranty National Bank, said looking ahead, even if the same number of jobs are created, the growth rate will be slower.

"Any place that goes through the kind of construction boom we saw on the Gulf Coast is going to grow slowly after the building begins to taper off," Guynn said.

Guynn said he expected manufacturing to be off this year. He said there is a weakness in apparel production in Mississippi and the region.

He said the poultry business suffered in 1998 because of the loss of the Russian import market and that could continue to impact the food processing industry into 1999.

Nationally, Guynn said "absent a large shock" such as more problems in Japan, Indochina and Latin America, 1999 should be a "very solid year but not a spectacular year."

Consumer spending should taper off but unemployment and inflation should remain low, he said.

The Federal Reserve Bank of Atlanta, one of 12 that make up the Federal Reserve System, monitors commercial and savings banks in the region to ensure they follow regulations.

JOBS APLENTY

Gov. Kirk Fordice has cited unprecedented growth since 1992. He has claimed more than 177,000 new jobs had been created during that time.

AT A GLANCE

ADDY competition deadline approaches

The deadline for entering the ADDY competition of the Ad Federation of South Mississippi is Tuesday.

The contest is the start of a three-tiered competition that allows local winners to advance to regional competition and regional winners to move up to the nation contest.

The local awards ceremony will be held Feb. 25 at the Lake Terrace Convention Center and is sponsored by Blakeney Communications, Cellular One, Copy Cats Printing, the *Hattiesburg American* and Knight Abbey Commerical Printers.

For contest information or to reserve $25 tickets for the ceremony, telephone Matt Martin at 549-9112 or e-mail Martin at matt@cellone-ms.com

Weevil meeting set

The Mississippi Boll Weevil Management Corp.'s annual convention will be held Jan. 23 in Grenada.

The meeting begins at 9 a.m. at Holmes Community College and includes a free catfish lunch.

Topics for discussion include eradication efforts, southeast eradication and containmnet and the need for continued eradication. Board members will be elected from the South Delta and Eastern districts.

For more information, telephone the organization's offce at (601) 325-2993.

PUBLIC MEETINGS

■ Hattiesburg Civitan Club, noon Wednesday; Farmer's Market; for information, Keith Barrett, 264-2528

■ Sales and Marketing Executives International, 5:15 p.m. third Tuesdays, Holiday Inn; for information, contact Pati Sims, 268-5809.

■ Pine Belt Military Enlisted Retired Association, 7 p.m., second Tuesday. For location, call Isaac Prine, 264-7140.

■ Pine Belt Area Retired Teacher Unit, 9:30 a.m., second Wednesdays, Sigler Building, 315 Conti St., Hattiesburg.

■ American Association of Retired Persons, fourth Tuesday, Sigler Building, Conti Street.

■ National Association of Retired Federal Employees, 11:30 a.m. second Wednesday, Forrest General Hospital cafeteria.

■ Hub City Kiwanis Club, noon Tuesday, Cane Creek Seafood. For information, contact David Turner, 268-8133.

■ Magnolia chapter, Retired Officers Association, 6:30 p.m., third Thursday, Camp Shelby Officers Club. For information, contact R.C. Trimble, 268-7086.

■ Hattiesburg Lions Club, Fridays, 11:30 a.m. until 1 p.m., William Carey College.

■ University Civitan Club, 7 a.m., Fridays, Elam Arms Cafeteria, Elam Arms Dormitory across Hardy from USM.

■ American Business Women's Association, Hattiesburg Charter Chapter; 5:30 p.m. networking, 6 p.m. dinner, fourth Tuesday, Comfort Inn; for information, Clara Boutwell, 583-7764.

■ Eliza Pillars Registered Nurses District VII. 10 a.m., fourth Saturday, Cloverleaf Mall Community Room.

■ Petal Kiwanis, noon, Tuesdays, Clubhouse, Petal.

■ American Business Women's Association, Pine Belt chapter; 11:30 a.m. networking, noon meeting, second Tuesday, Deposit Guaranty meeting room, South 40th Avenue; for information, Marika Warner, 582-1545

■ South Mississippi Art Association, 6:30 p.m., second Monday, Cloverleaf Mall Gallery near food court entrance. For information, call 544-SMAA or Scott Stahler, 264-6444.

■ To get your organization's meeting listed or to get news in happenings on the Money page, please send the information to the Hattiesburg American Business Section at 825 Main St., Hattiesburg, Miss., 39401, or fax it at 584-3130.

LOCAL STOCKS

The following are closing prices for Thursday's stocks of local interest listed on the New York Stock Exqhange.

"U" indicates a new 52-week high. "D" indicates a new 52-week low. "X" indicates ex-dividend or ex-rights.

NAME	SALES	LAST	CHG
AT&T	69452	82 1/8	-2 5/8
AmHes	3012	49 3/4	-2 3/16
Atlrich	16736	60 9/16	-2 1/2
Autozn	4755	33 5/8	-1/4
Bellso	30872	46 1/2	-1/2
Chevrn	10140	79 7/8	-1 1/4
Cocacl	50847	63 1/2	-1 11/16
Cmpq	90191	44 5/8	-1 1/4
Cooper	14881	43 1/4	-1/2
Disney	75100	36 1/8	NC
Enron	11616	60 1/2	-3 1/8
Entrgy	5696	30 1/4	-1/4
Exxon	42045	69 3/4	-3/4
Ford	29916	60 3/8	-1
Gannett	6662	63 7/8	-1 5/16
GenEl	50607	97 1/16	1/2
GenMtr	26110	81	-11/16
GaPac	7698	62 1/8	-1 7/8
Heilig	1744	6 13/16	-3/8
Hrcuis	9770	25 13/16	-11/16
IntPap	17040	44 1/16	-9/16
LaPac	1838	18 1/8	-5/16
Lowes	NC	NC	NC
MWL	1295	11 3/4	-3/16
NflkSo	8483	29	-1/16
Pnney	30814	39 7/8	-1 3/16
PepCo	50878	38 3/4	-1 1/2
PhpMr	75990	52 1/4	-1 3/4
RjrNab	18070	27 13/16	-13/16
Sears	15012	43 1/8	-3/4
Shney	2848	1 7/8	1/16
Sonat	5667	25	-1 5/8
Sthnco	10706	28 1/2	-3/16
Srbem	NC	NC	NC
Templ	1242	59 1/4	-13/16
Tchmrk	2927	34	-1/8
Tosco	3304	22 7/8	-1 3/16
WlGrns	20274	55 11/16	-2
Wmart	38927	79 3/4	-7/8
Wndys	4507	22 5/16	-7/8
William	21182	29 13/16	-3/16

LOCAL-OTC

NASDAQ quotations indicate highest bids and lowest offers from market maker security. Prices do not include retail security, retail markup or commission. First figure indicates close; the second, change.

Bank of Mississippi	NC	NC
FirstAmerican	NC	NC
Lamar Cap Corp	9 7/8	1/8
Phycor	7 1/4	-1/4
Union Planters	- NC	NC
WorldCm	71	-2 15/16
Sanderson Farms	16	NC
Trustmark Corp.	21 1/4	1/4
CBL & Associates	25 1/8	-5/16

Quotes are provided by the Hattiesburg office of Lagg Mason Wood Walker.

CONSUMER NEWS

What is your time worth? A Maryland company is offering free long-distance service to callers around the country if they agree to listen to advertisements first.

BroadPoint Communications, a Landover, Md.-based company, tested the plan in Pittsburgh last year and began offering it nationwide on Tuesday. President and CEO Perry Kamel says BroadPoint expects to have 1 million members by year's end.

People who sign up for the service, called Freeway, will get up to two minutes of free long-distance calling in the United States for each advertisement of 10-15 seconds that they listen to.

From Wire Reports

AHEAD IN MONEY

SATURDAY: Stock market
SUNDAY: Braswell column
TUESDAY: Personal finances
WEDNESDAY: Home care
THURSDAY: Real estate
FRIDAY: On the Internet

LET'S HEAR FROM YOU

To submit items for Business, send them to Business, Hattiesburg American, P.O. Box 1111, Hattiesburg, Miss. 39403 or fax them to 584-3130.

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